

AP PHOTO/THE STATESMAN



 	
Notice Control No.: A-553-6-2002	
(i) NAME:- (ii) SEX:- (iii) YEAR OF BIRTH:- (iv) PLACE OF BIRTH:- (v) LANGUAGE SPOKEN:- (vi) NATIONALITY:-	AMIR REZA KHAN AMIR MALE 5 January 1978 Calcutta, India Urdu, Bengali, Hindi, English INDIAN (CONFIRMED)
PHYSICAL DESCRIPTION	
HEIGHT:- COLOUR OF EYES:- COLOUR OF HAIR:- DISTINGUISHING MARKS:- CHARACTERISTICS:- OFFENCES:-	172 Cms. DARK BLACK N/A MEDIUM BUILD Kidnapping for ransom by use of firearms after criminal conspiracy

Terror on THE LINE

Top businessmen in Kolkata are increasingly getting extortion calls from the Indian Mujahideen. There may be more to this than meets the eye, especially after Pune.

By Abhijit Dasgupta

It's fear over the city. The recent revelation that at least three top businessmen of Kolkata have received extortion threats from the Indian Mujahideen (IM) has sent shock waves throughout the business community of West Bengal. More so, because this is the first time after the abduction of shoe giant Khadim's owner Partha Roy Burman in 2001, that any serious threat has been made to industry by terrorist outfits as significant as the IM. Top police officers will not talk on the record but what they are saying in private could be deeply disturbing. For one, apparently, the threat calls made by extortion king Amir Reza Khan were only three of those reported; at other times industrialists have chosen to pay up and keep quiet. The cash has almost always been paid in Delhi after making secret trips to the Capital, paying up and returning without making any public noises. Police sources have confirmed "suspicious

money transfers" in Delhi accounts but will not elaborate.

Why Kolkata suddenly, where it is generally believed that business barons are not so plentiful? Police sources say the reason is two-fold. Reza was based in Kolkata for decades before he fled to Karachi after he and Aftab Ansari (now on death row) masterminded the American Centre attack in 2002, and because the Mujahideen was facing tough times in Mumbai, Delhi and Gujarat, their main areas of operation. "Kolkata is a soft target for them and the businessmen here are clueless as to how to handle such threats. More often than not, they pay up secretly," says a source.

Industrialists have mostly chosen the softer option of paying up and keeping quiet.

Industrialists, usually a discreet lot, do not take the path of valour. One high profile businessman en route to Delhi reacted angrily, "No, I have not got any call and I am not going to Delhi to pay up. This is a business meeting." Most believe that hiring bodyguards is not an option either. "You only manage to attract more attention," says a businessman. Sources in the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry, while admitting that they are shaken, said Kolkata is now slowly turning into a prime target. "Outside of Jammu & Kashmir, the externally sponsored jihadis have always concentrated on Delhi, Mumbai, Ahmedabad, Bangalore and Jaipur. Kolkata and Chennai have been off their radar. Those days are obviously over," said one.

Businessmen are more scared because of the security conditions. For example, the state chief secretary, Asok Mohan Chakrabarti, while meeting members of the families of those who had received extortion threats on March 2, issued a glib statement: "I